



Benevolent House ACADEMY

Where Foundations Become Futures

PARENT HANDBOOK

508 N State Hwy 342, Red Oak, TX 75154
(469) 807-1221 | info@benevolenthouseacademy.org

Revised October 2026

Effective for each family upon signed acknowledgment

Where Foundations Become Futures

*This handbook contains the policies and procedures of Benevolent House Academy.
Please read carefully and sign the acknowledgment page at the end.*

A Letter to Our Families

Dear BHA Families,

Thank you for trusting us with your child. When we opened our doors on May 18, 2026, we prayed that Benevolent House Academy would become a place where children feel safe, loved, and excited to learn. Every day since, your children have answered that prayer. We have watched little ones take first steps, learn new words, make friends, and fill our classrooms with laughter.

To the families who joined us in those very first weeks, thank you for believing in what we were building. To every family who has joined us since, welcome. You are now part of something we have worked toward for a long time, and we do not take that trust lightly.

At Benevolent House Academy, we believe every child deserves to feel known, valued, and safe, and every family deserves to feel like a true partner. That belief is the heart of Known & Growing, our curriculum, and it shapes every page of this handbook, from how we care for our infants to how we guide behavior, celebrate birthdays, and keep everyone safe.

This handbook explains how we operate and what you can expect from us. Please take time to read it, keep it close, and come to us with any question at all. No question is too small. The page that follows gives you the most important details at a glance.

We are honored to grow alongside your family.

Warm regards,

The BHA Leadership Team

BHA at a Glance

Hours	Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM
Ages Served	6 weeks through 5 years. Licensed through age 13, with weekend, evening, and school-age summer care coming soon.
Arrival	All children arrive by 9:00 AM
Pickup	By 6:00 PM. A late fee of \$1 per minute applies after 6:00 PM.
Pickup Safety	Authorized adults only. Photo ID is checked for anyone our team does not yet know.
Tuition	Due each Friday for the following week, paid by autopay through Brightwheel
Communication	Brightwheel app for daily reports, photos, messages, and announcements. Please keep push notifications on.
Weather	We follow Red Oak ISD closures and delayed openings. Announcements go out on Brightwheel.
Closures	16 days each year (see Section 2). When Halloween falls on a weekday, we close at 5:00 PM.
When to Stay Home	Fever of 100.4 degrees F or higher, vomiting, or diarrhea. Return after 24 hours symptom-free without medication.
Meals	Breakfast, lunch, and afternoon snack included. BHA is an egg and nut free facility.
Included in Tuition	Diapers, wipes, pull-ups, and Similac 360 Total Care formula through 12 months
Every Friday	Your child brings home a portfolio of the week's work
Contact	(469) 807-1221 info@benevolenthouseacademy.org 508 N State Hwy 342, Red Oak, TX 75154
Licensing	Texas HHSC Child Care Regulation, Operation #1832672

TABLE OF CONTENTS

SECTION 1: WELCOME AND MISSION.....	8
Our Core Values.....	8
Safety and Security.....	8
Staff Identification.....	9
Contact Information.....	9
Handbook Review and Updates.....	9
SECTION 2: HOURS OF OPERATION AND CLOSURES.....	9
Arrival Time.....	9
Holiday and In-Service Closures.....	9
Early Closing on Halloween.....	10
SECTION 3: ENROLLMENT AND ADMISSION.....	10
SECTION 4: TUITION, FEES, AND PAYMENT POLICIES.....	10
Age Groups and Rate Placement.....	11
Fees.....	11
Discounts.....	11
Family Referral Credit.....	12
Payment Policies.....	12
SECTION 5: WHAT TUITION INCLUDES.....	12
Specialty Items.....	13
SECTION 6: PROGRAMS AND SERVICES.....	13
Coming Soon.....	13
SECTION 7: DAILY SCHEDULES AND ACTIVITIES.....	13
Seedlings (Infants) Classroom 0.....	14
Discoverers (Young Toddlers) Classroom 1.....	15
Explorers (Older Toddlers) Classroom 2.....	16
Innovators (Preschool) Classroom 3.....	17
Scholars (Pre-K) Classroom 4.....	18
SECTION 8: CURRICULUM AND EDUCATIONAL APPROACH.....	18
Screen Time.....	19
SECTION 9: DISCIPLINE AND GUIDANCE.....	19
Approved Guidance Techniques.....	19
Prohibited Methods.....	20
Behavior Classification and Response.....	20
Suspension and Expulsion.....	21

Biting Policy.....	21
Physical Aggression Policy (Hitting, Kicking, Pushing).....	22
SECTION 10: RELEASE OF CHILDREN AND AUTHORIZED PICKUP	23
SECTION 11: SIGN-IN AND SIGN-OUT PROCEDURES.....	23
SECTION 12: LATE PICKUP POLICY.....	23
Late Pickup Fee.....	23
If We Cannot Reach You.....	23
Chronic Late Pickup.....	23
SECTION 13: PARENT COMMUNICATION (BRIGHTWHEEL).....	24
SECTION 14: PARENT RIGHTS AND VISITATION.....	24
Breastfeeding.....	24
Access to Records and Reports.....	24
Access to Minimum Standards and Regulatory Information.....	24
Parent Rights Under Texas Law (TAC 746.521).....	25
SECTION 15: PARENT INVOLVEMENT AND PARTICIPATION.....	25
SECTION 16: ILLNESS AND EXCLUSION CRITERIA.....	25
Illness During the Day.....	26
Communicable Disease Notification.....	26
SECTION 17: MEDICATION ADMINISTRATION.....	26
Products Treated as Medication.....	26
General Requirements.....	26
The Product Label Governs.....	27
Products Not Administered.....	27
Commercial Products Only.....	27
Sunscreen and Insect Repellent.....	28
Medication and Product Decision Guide.....	28
Medication Safety Plan.....	28
Unable to Reach Parent Regarding Medication.....	28
Epinephrine Auto-Injectors.....	29
SECTION 18: MEDICAL EMERGENCIES AND INJURIES.....	29
SECTION 19: HEALTH CHECKS.....	29
SECTION 20: ALLERGIES AND SPECIAL DIETARY NEEDS.....	29
SECTION 21: NUTRITION AND MEALS.....	29
Outside Food Policy.....	30
Menu Substitutions and Food Preferences.....	30
Infant Feeding.....	31

SECTION 22: PHYSICAL ACTIVITY AND OUTDOOR PLAY.....	31
Benefits of Physical Activity.....	31
Daily Physical Activity.....	31
Settings for Physical Activity.....	31
Walking Path and Stroller Walks.....	31
Outdoor Play.....	32
Physical Activity on Extreme Weather Days.....	32
Clothing for Physical Activity.....	32
SECTION 23: SAFE SLEEP POLICY (INFANTS).....	32
SECTION 24: NAP AND REST TIME.....	33
SECTION 25: WHAT TO BRING AND LABELING REQUIREMENTS.....	33
SECTION 26: CLOTHING GUIDELINES FOR CHILDREN.....	33
SECTION 27: PERSONAL ITEMS, JEWELRY, AND PROHIBITED ITEMS.....	33
Items Worn by Children.....	34
Hair Ornaments.....	34
Personal Belongings.....	34
Items Found in the Classroom.....	34
SECTION 28: BIRTHDAYS AND CELEBRATIONS.....	35
SECTION 29: ANIMALS.....	35
SECTION 30: FIELD TRIPS.....	35
SECTION 31: WATER ACTIVITIES.....	35
SECTION 32: TRANSPORTATION.....	36
SECTION 33: WEEKEND AND EVENING CARE.....	36
SECTION 34: EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS.....	36
SECTION 35: CHILD ABUSE AND NEGLECT PREVENTION AND REPORTING.....	36
Prevention and Awareness.....	36
How to Report Suspected Abuse or Neglect.....	37
How to Contact Licensing.....	37
SECTION 36: IMMUNIZATION REQUIREMENTS.....	37
SECTION 37: HEARING AND VISION SCREENING.....	38
SECTION 38: LIABILITY INSURANCE NOTICE.....	38
SECTION 39: GANG-FREE ZONE NOTICE.....	38
SECTION 40: INCLUSIVE SERVICES FOR CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL CARE NEEDS.....	38
SECTION 41: VACCINE-PREVENTABLE DISEASES.....	39
SECTION 42: QUESTIONS, CONCERNS, AND GRIEVANCES.....	39
SECTION 43: TERMINATION OF SERVICES AND WITHDRAWAL.....	39

Withdrawal by the Parent.....39

Disenrollment by the Center.....39

Notice of Disenrollment.....40

Refunds.....40

SECTION 44: WEATHER CLOSURES AND CENTER CLOSURES.....40

 How Families Are Notified.....40

 Tuition During Closures.....41

SECTION 45: POLICY AUTHORITY, EXCEPTIONS, AND UNIFORM APPLICATION.....41

 Decision-Making Authority.....41

 The Center May Decline a Request.....41

 Policies Apply Uniformly.....41

SECTION 46: PARENT ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF RECEIPT.....42

SECTION 1: WELCOME AND MISSION

Welcome to Benevolent House Academy! We are a licensed childcare center in Red Oak, Texas. Benevolent House Academy is licensed for 24-hour care for children from 6 weeks through 13 years of age, with a licensed capacity of 52 children. We are growing in phases: today we provide full-time infant, toddler, and preschool care for children 6 weeks through 5 years of age, and weekend, evening, and school-age summer care are coming next (see Section 6). We are licensed by the Texas Health and Human Services Commission (HHSC) Child Care Regulation division, Operation #1832672.

At Benevolent House Academy, we believe every child deserves a safe, nurturing, and joyful environment where they can learn, grow, and thrive. Our programs are designed to be developmentally appropriate for each age group, and our caregivers are trained to support the whole child, including their social, emotional, physical, and cognitive development.

Our staff is trained in best practices for early childhood education, including responsive caregiving, positive guidance, and social-emotional development. We understand that every child is unique, and we are committed to building strong, trusting relationships with both children and families.

Our Core Values

- **Safety.** The physical and emotional safety of every child is our highest priority.
- **Nurturing Care.** We provide warm, responsive care that helps children feel safe, seen, and valued.
- **Respect.** We treat every child, family, and team member with dignity and respect.
- **Partnership.** We are partners with parents in supporting their children's growth and development.
- **Excellence.** We hold ourselves to the highest standards of quality, compliance, and professionalism.

Safety and Security

Families trust us with what matters most, and these practices are in place every day:

- **Cameras.** Cameras record in every classroom and around the full perimeter of our building, inside and out. To protect the privacy of every child, the cameras are not available for live viewing. Recordings are reviewed by the BHA leadership team whenever a concern or incident needs a closer look.
- **Locked doors.** Our front and back doors stay locked at all times.
- **Secure pickup.** Children are released only to adults listed on the authorized pickup list, and photo ID is checked for anyone our team does not yet know (see Section 10).
- **Trained team.** Every team member is background checked and trained in CPR and first aid.
- **Licensed and inspected.** BHA is licensed by HHSC, Operation #1832672. Our inspection history is public and is also available for review at the center (see Section 14).

Staff Identification

All Benevolent House Academy employees wear BHA-branded shirts during operating hours so that parents, visitors, and children can easily identify authorized staff members at all times.

Contact Information

Benevolent House Academy, 508 N State Hwy 342, Red Oak, TX 75154. Phone: (469) 807-1221. Email: info@benevolenthouseacademy.org. Executive Director: Tanya Orr. Chief Operating Officer: Christopher Orr. Directors: Vanessa Wright and Haddie Mashburn. Together, they make up the BHA leadership team.

Handbook Review and Updates

This handbook contains the written operational policies referenced in Section 4 (Receipt of Written Operational Policies) of HHSC Form 2935, Admission Information. By signing Form 2935, families acknowledge receipt of these policies, all of which are described in this handbook.

The Executive Director reviews this handbook at least once per year and updates it as needed to reflect changes in Texas licensing requirements, center operations, or best practices. When a policy changes, families are notified in writing through Brightwheel and receive an updated copy of the handbook or the updated section. Questions about handbook content may be directed to the BHA leadership team at any time.

SECTION 2: HOURS OF OPERATION AND CLOSURES

Benevolent House Academy is open Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM. The center is licensed for 24-hour care, and weekend and evening care are coming soon (see Section 6).

Arrival Time

All children must arrive by 9:00 AM so they can settle in and take part in the morning learning activities. Late arrivals require a doctor's note or prior written approval from the BHA leadership team.

Holiday and In-Service Closures

The center is closed on the following 16 days each year, including two staff in-service days:

- New Year's Day
- Martin Luther King Jr. Day
- Presidents' Day (staff in-service day)
- Good Friday
- Memorial Day
- Juneteenth
- Independence Day (July 4th)

- Labor Day
- Second Monday in October (staff in-service day)
- Wednesday before Thanksgiving
- Thanksgiving Day
- Day After Thanksgiving
- December 23
- Christmas Eve
- Christmas Day
- New Year's Eve

The staff in-service days begin in 2027. If a holiday falls on a Saturday, the center will be closed on the preceding Friday. If a holiday falls on a Sunday, the center will be closed on the following Monday.

Early Closing on Halloween

When Halloween falls on a weekday, the center closes at 5:00 PM.

Tuition is due regardless of holiday closures and early closings. Families are notified through Brightwheel ahead of each closure and early closing.

SECTION 3: ENROLLMENT AND ADMISSION

Before a child is admitted to Benevolent House Academy, the parent or guardian must complete and sign the following:

- Enrollment application with complete admission information
- Child-care enrollment agreement (acknowledging receipt of these operational policies)
- Emergency contact and authorized pickup form
- Current immunization records (or approved exemption documentation)
- Statement of the child's health from a health-care professional
- Food allergy emergency plan (if applicable)
- Medication authorization form (if applicable)
- Liability insurance notice acknowledgment (Attachment A)
- Infant feeding plan and safe sleep acknowledgment (infant enrollment only)

All admission information must be signed by the parent before the child's first day. Admission information is reviewed and updated at least every 6 months. Infant feeding plans are updated monthly. Parents are responsible for notifying the center immediately of any changes to contact information, authorized pickup persons, allergies, or medical conditions.

SECTION 4: TUITION, FEES, AND PAYMENT POLICIES

Current tuition rates and fees are listed on the Benevolent House Academy Fee Schedule, which is provided at enrollment and whenever rates change. Tuition rates are weekly and cover full-time enrollment, Monday through Friday. Tuition is due each Friday in advance of the following week of care. Rates and fees are subject to change with 60 days of written notice to enrolled families.

Age Groups and Rate Placement

Weekly tuition is based on your child's age group on the current Fee Schedule: Infant (6 weeks to 11 months), Young Toddler (12 to 17 months), Toddler (18 to 35 months), Preschool (3 years), and Pre-K (4 to 5 years). Two parts of your child's care also affect rate placement, because they reflect care our team continues to provide:

- **Formula.** Benevolent House Academy provides Similac 360 Total Care formula for infants through 12 months of age. A child who is still drinking formula during the day at BHA remains at the infant rate until the child has moved to whole milk. After the first birthday, the family supplies the formula, and the infant rate continues while the child is on formula because our caregivers continue to prepare bottles and provide infant feeding care.
- **Pull-ups.** A child who turns 3 and is not yet potty trained remains at the toddler rate until the child is potty trained. Benevolent House Academy continues to provide pull-ups during this time.

Your child's rate is based on the care your child receives each day, not on supplies. Every child reaches these milestones in their own time, and there is never any pressure to rush them. Our teachers are always glad to partner with you along the way.

Definitions. "Moved to whole milk" means the child drinks whole milk instead of formula during the day at BHA. "Potty trained" means the child wears underwear all day and uses the toilet with only occasional reminders and accidents.

Medical and developmental needs. If a child's continued formula use is a medical need documented by the child's health-care professional, or a child is not yet potty trained because of a disability, developmental delay, or medical condition, the child moves to the next rate on the normal age schedule, consistent with the Americans with Disabilities Act.

When a new rate begins. A rate change based on age or on one of these milestones applies on the next invoice after the change occurs.

Fees

- **Registration:** One-time and non-refundable, as listed on the Fee Schedule.
- **Annual Supply and Activity Fee:** Due September 1st each year, as listed on the Fee Schedule. The fee is prorated for families who enroll after September 1st, and the full fee is due each September 1st after that.
- **Late Pickup:** \$1 per minute after 6:00 PM (see Section 12).
- **Late Payment:** \$25.
- **Returned Payment:** \$35, in addition to any late payment fee.

Discounts

Discounts are available for siblings, military families, first responders, and teachers and educators. Discount amounts and verification requirements are listed on the Fee Schedule. One discount per family. Discounts cannot be combined. The sibling discount applies to the lower tuition rate. Verification is required at enrollment and annually by September 1st. Discounts are removed if verification lapses.

Family Referral Credit

We are grateful when families share Benevolent House Academy with friends and neighbors. When a family you refer enrolls, your family receives a one-time tuition credit in the amount listed on the current Fee Schedule.

- Your family must be currently enrolled, with tuition paid up to date.
- The new family must name your family on their enrollment application, or tell the BHA leadership team, before their child's first day.
- The credit is applied to your next invoice after the referred child has attended and paid tuition for 4 consecutive weeks.
- The credit applies to tuition only, has no cash value, and cannot be transferred. For families receiving child care subsidies, the credit applies to the family's share of tuition.
- Children already living in your household do not qualify as referrals.
- The referral credit is a one-time credit, not a discount, so it may be used along with an approved discount. There is no limit to the number of referral credits a family can earn.

Payment Policies

- Tuition is due by the Friday before the week of service. Payment reserves your child's spot for the coming week.
- Tuition is processed by automatic payment (autopay). It is the parent's responsibility to keep a valid payment method on file.
- Invoices are emailed through Brightwheel three days before payment is due. All billing and payments are handled through the Brightwheel platform.
- To keep your child's spot ready and their care uninterrupted, payment must be received by the Friday before each week of service. If a payment has not come through by then, we will reach out so we can resolve it together before the week begins. Care resumes as soon as payment is complete. A late payment fee applies (see Fees above).
- Tuition is paid weekly in advance, and we are not able to offer payment plans or partial billing.
- Your weekly tuition reserves your child's specific spot in our care, which is held just for them whether or not they attend every day. Because we are holding that place, tuition is charged in full and is not prorated for days your child is out, including vacations, travel, remote-work or seasonal schedules, illness, holidays, or weather closures.
- Two weeks of written notice is required for withdrawal. Tuition is due during the notice period.
- If the center is closed 5 or more consecutive business days due to weather or emergency, tuition credits will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis.
- Texas Workforce Commission (TWC) Child Care Services subsidies are accepted. Co-payment is due by the first day of each week.

SECTION 5: WHAT TUITION INCLUDES

Full-time enrollment includes the following at no additional charge:

- Breakfast, lunch, and afternoon snack daily (USDA CACFP program).
- Standard brand diapers, wipes, and pull-ups. Brands vary based on availability.

- Similac 360 Total Care infant formula for infants through 12 months of age (see Section 4).
- All curriculum materials, classroom supplies, and learning activities.
- On-site special events, celebrations, and enrichment activities.
- Developmentally appropriate, high-quality programming.

Specialty Items

If your child requires a specific brand, hypoallergenic, sensitive skin, or specialty formula, diapers, or wipes due to allergies, medical needs, or personal preference, you must provide those items. Families also provide formula for children who use formula after their first birthday. There is no tuition reduction for parent-supplied items. All parent-provided items must be labeled with the child's first and last name.

SECTION 6: PROGRAMS AND SERVICES

Benevolent House Academy is licensed for children 6 weeks through 13 years of age and is opening its programs in phases. Our current program is full-time infant, toddler, and preschool care for children 6 weeks through 5 years of age, Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM. Children are cared for in five age-based classrooms:

- **Seedlings:** Infants, 6 weeks to 11 months
- **Discoverers:** Young toddlers, 12 to 17 months
- **Explorers:** Older toddlers, 18 to 35 months
- **Innovators:** Preschool, 3 years
- **Scholars:** Pre-K, 4 to 5 years

Coming Soon

We are preparing to grow our programs. Families may join the interest list for any of these programs through the BHA leadership team or our website:

- **Weekend Care:** Daytime care on Saturdays and Sundays for children ages 2 through 13.
- **Evening Care:** Evening care for children ages 2 and older.
- **Summer Care for School-Age Children:** A summer program for school-age children, including field trips.

The schedule, rates, and any additional policies for each program will be shared with families in writing before the program begins.

SECTION 7: DAILY SCHEDULES AND ACTIVITIES

Each classroom follows a daily schedule that is posted in the room and tailored to the developmental needs of the age group. The schedules below reflect the daily rhythm of each classroom. Actual times may shift slightly to meet the needs of the children, and infant schedules always follow each child's individual needs and parent instructions.

Seedlings (Infants) | Classroom 0

Infants follow individualized schedules based on each child's needs and parent instructions, and are fed on demand. Diapering occurs as needed (at least every two hours). All infants are placed on their backs to sleep in bare cribs, and are never left to sleep in swings, bouncers, or car seats. The rhythm below is a general guide. Curriculum: Known & Growing (BHA's proprietary whole-child curriculum).

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, warm greetings, feeding on demand, diapering, tummy time	Secure attachment, responsive care
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast and bottles (solids per each infant's feeding plan)	Nutrition, self-feeding
9:00 - 9:45 AM	Known & Growing block: sensory play, music, board books, feelings check-in	Sensory and language development
9:45 - 10:15 AM	Tummy time, floor play, reaching and grasping	Gross and fine motor
10:15 - 10:45 AM	Outdoor stroller walk on the walking path, as tolerated	Fresh air, environmental awareness
10:45 - 11:30 AM	Bottles on demand, mirror play, soft-toy exploration	Self-awareness, nutrition
11:30 - 12:00 PM	Lunch and bottles (solids per feeding plan)	Nutrition, self-feeding
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Diapering, lullabies, wind-down	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap and rest on demand (bare cribs, placed on back)	Physical rest
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Afternoon snack and bottles	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Outdoor stroller walk on the walking path, as tolerated	Fresh air, sensory
3:30 - 5:00 PM	Floor play, caregiver interaction, songs, reading	Language, attachment
5:00 - 6:00 PM	Feeding on demand, calm play, pickup	Responsive care

Posted per 26 TAC 746.2206. This plan provides a minimum of two daily outdoor opportunities (weather permitting), a balance of active and quiet, group and individual, and caregiver-initiated and child-initiated activities, regular CACFP meals and snacks, and supervised rest. For infants birth through 12 months, outdoor play is offered as tolerated by each infant (746.2206(1)(A)). Infant stroller walks use the walking path and are separate from the playground.

Drinking water is offered and available to children throughout the day.

Discoverers (Young Toddlers) | Classroom 1

Curriculum: Known & Growing (BHA's proprietary whole-child curriculum). Activity plans are posted and updated regularly.

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, free play with soft toys, social-emotional greeting	Separation transition, social-emotional
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-feeding, nutrition
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (balls, ride-on toys)	Gross motor, fresh air
9:30 - 10:15 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time, music and movement, finger plays, feelings check-in	Language, gross motor, listening
10:15 - 11:00 AM	Learning centers: sensory bins, stacking and sorting, push-and-pull toys	Fine motor, cause and effect
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Story time, board books, puppet play	Language, early literacy
11:30 - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-feeding, social interaction
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Diapering, Quiet Reset Space, wind-down	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap on individual cots	Physical rest
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition, self-help
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, social
3:30 - 4:30 PM	Art exploration (finger paint, large crayons), sensory table	Fine motor, creativity
4:30 - 5:15 PM	Free-choice centers, music	Choice, independence
5:15 - 6:00 PM	Quiet free play, books, pickup	Wind-down, choice

Posted per 26 TAC 746.2206. This plan provides a minimum of two daily outdoor opportunities (weather permitting), a balance of active and quiet, group and individual, and caregiver-initiated and child-initiated activities, regular CACFP meals and snacks, and supervised rest.

Outdoor times are staggered so that only one classroom uses the playground at a time. This room receives a minimum of 60 minutes outdoors and 60 minutes of moderate to vigorous active play daily.

Drinking water is offered and available to children throughout the day.

Explorers (Older Toddlers) | Classroom 2

Curriculum: Known & Growing (BHA's proprietary whole-child curriculum). Activity plans are posted and updated regularly.

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, free play, table toys, social-emotional greeting	Social skills, fine motor
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-help, nutrition
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time (songs, finger plays, feelings check-in); letter, name, and pre-writing woven in	Language, social, listening
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (ride-on toys, balls, chalk)	Gross motor, sensory
10:00 - 11:00 AM	Learning centers: playdough, blocks, pretend play, sensory	Cognitive, fine motor, imagination
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Story time, flannel board stories	Literacy, vocabulary
11:30 - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-feeding, manners
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting and diapering, wind-down	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap on individual cots	Physical rest
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Themed art, music and dance	Creativity, expression
3:30 - 4:00 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, exploration
4:00 - 5:00 PM	Learning centers, free choice	Choice, fine motor
5:00 - 5:30 PM	Optional educational screen time (up to 30 minutes)	Wind-down, choice
5:30 - 6:00 PM	Quiet free play, books, pickup	Wind-down, choice

Posted per 26 TAC 746.2206. This plan provides a minimum of two daily outdoor opportunities (weather permitting), a balance of active and quiet, group and individual, and caregiver-initiated and child-initiated activities, regular CACFP meals and snacks, and supervised rest.

Screen time follows 26 TAC 746.2207: ages two and older only, educational, no more than one hour per day, never during meals, snacks, or rest, and turned off when not in use.

Children under age 2 do a quiet alternative activity, such as books or puzzles, during screen time.

Outdoor times are staggered so that only one classroom uses the playground at a time. This room receives a minimum of 60 minutes outdoors and 60 minutes of moderate to vigorous active play daily.

Drinking water is offered and available to children throughout the day.

Innovators (Preschool) | Classroom 3

Curriculum: Known & Growing (BHA's proprietary whole-child curriculum). Activity plans are posted and updated regularly.

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, table activities (puzzles, books), greeting	Fine motor, literacy
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-help, social
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time (calendar, weather, feelings check-in, letter of the week); name and pre-writing woven in	Math, literacy, social-emotional
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Learning centers, round one: science, writing, art	STEM, literacy, creativity
10:00 - 10:30 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (climbing, group games)	Gross motor, cooperation
10:30 - 11:15 AM	Learning centers, round two: dramatic play, blocks, manipulatives	Social, cognitive
11:15 - 11:30 AM	Story time, read-aloud	Comprehension, vocabulary
11:30 - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-help, conversation
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting, quiet transition	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap and rest (quiet activities for non-sleepers after 30 minutes)	Rest, self-regulation
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Themed art, music, or STEM activity	Creativity, cognitive
3:30 - 4:00 PM	Free-choice centers	Choice, social
4:00 - 4:30 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, social
4:30 - 5:15 PM	Music and movement, dramatic play	Active play, expression
5:15 - 5:45 PM	Optional educational screen time (up to 30 minutes)	Wind-down, choice
5:45 - 6:00 PM	Quiet free play, puzzles, pickup	Wind-down, choice

Posted per 26 TAC 746.2206. This plan provides a minimum of two daily outdoor opportunities (weather permitting), a balance of active and quiet, group and individual, and caregiver-initiated and child-initiated activities, regular CACFP meals and snacks, and supervised rest.

Screen time follows 26 TAC 746.2207: ages two and older only, educational, no more than one hour per day, never during meals, snacks, or rest, and turned off when not in use.

Outdoor times are staggered so that only one classroom uses the playground at a time. This room receives a minimum of 60 minutes outdoors and 90 minutes of moderate to vigorous active play daily.

Drinking water is offered and available to children throughout the day.

Scholars (Pre-K) | Classroom 4

Curriculum: Known & Growing (BHA's proprietary whole-child curriculum). Activity plans are posted and updated regularly.

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, journaling, table activities, greeting	Literacy, fine motor
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-help, social skills
9:00 - 9:45 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time (calendar, phonics, number of the day, feelings check-in, sharing); letter, name, and writing woven in	Math, literacy, social-emotional
9:45 - 10:30 AM	Small group and learning centers: writing, math, science, reading	School readiness, STEM, literacy
10:30 - 11:00 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (organized games, obstacle course)	Gross motor, teamwork
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Story time and read-aloud, language activities	Comprehension, vocabulary
11:30 - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-help, conversation, manners
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting, quiet transition	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap and rest (quiet activities for non-sleepers after 30 minutes)	Rest, self-regulation
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:45 PM	Art, music, dramatic play, or STEM challenge	Creativity, problem-solving
3:45 - 4:30 PM	Free-choice learning centers	Choice, social
4:30 - 5:00 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, free choice
5:00 - 5:30 PM	Optional educational screen time (up to 30 minutes)	Social skills, wind-down
5:30 - 6:00 PM	Board games, books, free play, pickup	Social skills, wind-down

Posted per 26 TAC 746.2206. This plan provides a minimum of two daily outdoor opportunities (weather permitting), a balance of active and quiet, group and individual, and caregiver-initiated and child-initiated activities, regular CACFP meals and snacks, and supervised rest.

Screen time follows 26 TAC 746.2207: ages two and older only, educational, no more than one hour per day, never during meals, snacks, or rest, and turned off when not in use.

Outdoor times are staggered so that only one classroom uses the playground at a time. This room receives a minimum of 60 minutes outdoors and 90 minutes of moderate to vigorous active play daily.

Drinking water is offered and available to children throughout the day.

SECTION 8: CURRICULUM AND EDUCATIONAL APPROACH

Benevolent House Academy provides a developmentally appropriate, play-based learning environment designed to support the whole child. Every classroom, from infants through Pre-K, uses Known & Growing, the curriculum created by Benevolent House Academy and rooted in our mission.

Known & Growing is a whole-child approach that places social-emotional learning and character development at the heart of each day. It guides our daily feelings check-ins, our monthly character traits, letter and early-literacy learning, and original books and activities written by our

team. Known & Growing reflects what we most hope to instill in every child: that they are known, valued, and growing in character, confidence, and a love of learning.

Our approach balances structured learning with child-initiated exploration, and every classroom is designed to foster curiosity, confidence, and a love of learning.

Our programs incorporate four practices that make BHA unique:

- **Character Development:** Each month, the center focuses on a character trait such as kindness, courage, patience, or respect. Activities, stories, and recognition are tied to the monthly trait, helping children build strong character and positive habits.
- **Daily Social-Emotional Check-Ins:** Every classroom begins the day with a relationship-building routine that includes feelings boards, morning circles, and calm-down corners. Children learn to identify, name, and regulate their emotions in a supportive environment.
- **Family Connection:** We honor and celebrate the diversity of family structures. Our classroom activities, books, and discussions reflect that families come in many forms, and every family is valued.
- **Friday Portfolios:** Each Friday, children bring home a portfolio of the week's work so families can see what their child has been learning and celebrate their growth together.

Activity plans are posted in each classroom and updated regularly. Parents are welcome to ask questions about classroom activities at any time.

Screen Time

Benevolent House Academy limits screen time in accordance with Texas Administrative Code Section 746.2207. Screen time is not used for children under 2 years of age. For children 2 years and older, screen time is educational, related to planned learning activities, does not exceed one hour per day, and is never used during meals, snacks, or rest, or as a substitute for physical activity, outdoor play, or caregiver interaction. Screen time is always supervised by a caregiver and is turned off when not in use. At BHA, the Explorers, Innovators, and Scholars classrooms may include up to 30 minutes of optional educational screen time near the end of the day, well within the state limit. Any child under 2 in the Explorers classroom does a different activity during that time.

SECTION 9: DISCIPLINE AND GUIDANCE

Benevolent House Academy uses positive, developmentally appropriate guidance techniques. We believe that children do their best when they feel safe, connected, and understood. Our caregivers are trained to respond to challenging behavior with empathy, consistency, and patience.

Approved Guidance Techniques

- Positive reinforcement and encouragement
- Helping children name and manage their emotions
- Redirection to appropriate activities
- Setting clear, consistent limits
- Offering age-appropriate choices

- Natural and logical consequences
- Modeling appropriate behavior
- Brief supervised separation from the group when necessary (not to exceed one minute per year of the child's age)

Prohibited Methods

The following discipline methods are strictly prohibited at Benevolent House Academy. Any employee who uses a prohibited method is subject to immediate termination.

- Corporal punishment of any kind (spanking, hitting, slapping, pinching, shaking, biting)
- Verbal abuse (threats, humiliation, profanity, shaming, derogatory remarks)
- Punishment associated with food, rest, or toileting
- Placing a child in a dark or locked room
- Requiring physical exercise as punishment
- Any form of discipline that is frightening or humiliating to a child

Behavior Classification and Response

To ensure consistency and transparency, Benevolent House Academy classifies behaviors into three levels. The center's response is proportional to the severity and frequency of the behavior.

Level 1 Behaviors (Low-Level Concerns): These are developmentally typical behaviors that are addressed through routine guidance techniques. Examples include not following classroom rules, difficulty sharing or taking turns, minor verbal conflicts with peers, crying or whining, and refusing to participate in activities. Response: Caregivers use redirection, emotion coaching, and positive reinforcement. Parents are informed through daily reports if the behavior is persistent.

Level 2 Behaviors (Moderate Concerns): These are behaviors that are disruptive, persistent, or that may cause minor harm to the child, other children, or staff. Examples include biting, hitting, kicking, or pushing other children; throwing objects at others; persistent defiance or refusal to follow safety rules; destructive behavior toward classroom materials or property; and spitting at others. Response: The behavior is documented in an incident report. The parent is notified on the day of occurrence. If the behavior is recurring, the behavior escalation process below is initiated.

Level 3 Behaviors (Serious Safety Concerns): These are behaviors that pose an immediate safety risk to the child, other children, or staff. Examples include severe physical aggression causing injury to another child or staff member, biting that breaks the skin, elopement (leaving the classroom or building without permission), self-injurious behavior, and threatening behavior toward staff or children. Response: The child is immediately separated from the group in a supervised area. The parent is contacted for immediate pickup. The behavior escalation process is initiated at the appropriate step based on severity, and may begin at Step 3 or Step 4 for the most serious incidents.

Suspension and Expulsion

Benevolent House Academy is committed to working with families before considering suspension or disenrollment. If a child's behavior is a concern, the following process will be followed:

1. **Step 1: Parent Conference.** A member of the BHA leadership team and the caregiver will meet with the parent to discuss the behavior, identify possible causes, and develop a plan together. Strategies may include schedule adjustments, classroom changes, or referrals to outside resources.
2. **Step 2: Written Behavior Plan.** If the behavior continues, a written behavior plan will be developed in partnership with the family. The plan will outline specific goals, strategies, and a timeline for improvement.
3. **Step 3: Temporary Suspension.** If the behavior plan does not result in improvement and the child's behavior continues to pose a safety risk to themselves, other children, or staff, the child may be temporarily suspended (1 to 5 days) to allow time for the family and center to reassess the plan.
4. **Step 4: Disenrollment.** If all reasonable interventions have been exhausted and the behavior continues to pose a persistent safety risk, the center may disenroll the child. Parents will receive 5 business days of written notice with the reasons for the decision.

In cases where a child's behavior poses an immediate danger to themselves or others (such as severe physical aggression causing injury), the center may temporarily remove the child from the classroom and require immediate parent pickup. The behavior escalation process will begin at the appropriate step based on the severity of the incident.

Biting Policy

Benevolent House Academy recognizes that biting is a common, developmentally typical behavior in infants and toddlers. Young children may bite because they lack the language to express frustration, excitement, or sensory needs. Our response to biting is rooted in understanding the reason behind the behavior while keeping all children safe. The safety of every child is our first priority. While we respond to the biting child with patience and developmentally appropriate guidance, we will also take prompt action to protect the other children in the classroom, including increased or one-on-one supervision of the biting child and, when necessary, removing that child from the group during high-risk periods until the behavior is under better support.

- **First incident:** The caregiver separates the children, comforts the child who was bitten, and provides first aid. The biting child is redirected using age-appropriate guidance. Both families are notified on the day of occurrence through an incident report. The caregiver documents the circumstances (time of day, activity, possible triggers) to identify patterns.
- **Second incident (or emerging pattern):** The BHA leadership team reviews the documentation for patterns (time of day, specific triggers, transitions, specific children involved). The caregiver adjusts the classroom environment to reduce triggers (additional supervision during high-risk times, seating changes, sensory tools). The parent of the biting child is contacted for a conference (Step 1) to discuss what is being observed and to develop strategies together.

- **Third incident or continued pattern:** A written behavior plan (Step 2) is developed with the family. The plan may include shadow supervision (a caregiver positioned within arm's reach during high-risk times), introduction of sensory alternatives (teething toys, chew necklaces for age-appropriate children), schedule modifications, or referral to Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) or a behavioral specialist for evaluation. The BHA leadership team monitors the plan daily.
- **Persistent biting after the plan is in place:** If biting continues despite consistent implementation of the behavior plan and the safety of other children remains at risk, temporary suspension (Step 3) may be used to allow the family and center to reassess whether additional support or a different environment may better meet the child's needs. Disenrollment (Step 4) is considered only after all reasonable interventions have been exhausted.

At every step, caregivers respond with empathy and without shaming. Biting is never treated as willful misbehavior in infants and toddlers. The goal is always to identify what the child is communicating and to teach alternative ways to express that need.

Physical Aggression Policy (Hitting, Kicking, Pushing)

Physical aggression such as hitting, kicking, pushing, or throwing objects at others is addressed with the same trauma-informed, progressive approach. The center's response considers the child's age, developmental stage, and the context of the behavior.

- **First incident:** The caregiver intervenes immediately to ensure safety, separates the children involved, and uses emotion coaching to help the child identify what they were feeling. The child who was hurt is comforted and given first aid if needed. Both families are notified through an incident report on the day of occurrence. The incident is documented with context (triggers, circumstances, time of day).
- **Second incident (or emerging pattern):** The BHA leadership team reviews the documentation for patterns. The caregiver implements targeted strategies (proximity supervision, offering choices before frustration escalates, teaching replacement behaviors such as using words or walking away). A parent conference (Step 1) is scheduled to share observations and develop a collaborative plan.
- **Third incident or continued pattern:** A written behavior plan (Step 2) is developed with the family. The plan may include individualized support strategies, a modified schedule, a classroom change, visual cue cards for emotional regulation, or referral for outside evaluation or support services. The BHA leadership team monitors the plan and communicates progress to the family regularly.
- **Persistent aggression after the plan is in place:** If the behavior continues to pose a safety risk to other children or staff despite consistent implementation of the plan, temporary suspension (Step 3) and, if necessary, disenrollment (Step 4) may follow. These steps are taken only when the center has exhausted its ability to maintain a safe environment for all children.

If a single incident of physical aggression results in serious injury to another child or a staff member, the center may require immediate parent pickup and begin the escalation process at Step 3 or Step 4 based on the severity of the incident. Parents of the injured child are notified immediately and provided with a written incident report.

SECTION 10: RELEASE OF CHILDREN AND AUTHORIZED PICKUP

Children will only be released to individuals listed on the child's authorized pickup form. If a caregiver does not know the person picking up the child, including anyone picking up for the first time, the caregiver will request a valid government-issued photo ID and verify the name against the authorized pickup list before releasing the child. If the person is not on the authorized list, the caregiver will contact the parent to obtain verbal or written authorization.

No child will be released to an unauthorized person under any circumstances. If a custody order restricts pickup by a specific individual, a copy of the order must be provided to the center and will be maintained in the child's file. All caregivers will be informed.

IMPORTANT: It is the parent's responsibility to keep the authorized pickup list current. Changes must be submitted in writing to the BHA leadership team.

SECTION 11: SIGN-IN AND SIGN-OUT PROCEDURES

Parents are required to sign their child in and out of the center each day using the Brightwheel app. The sign-in/sign-out record serves as the daily tracking system required by Texas licensing and must be completed by the parent or authorized pickup person. Do not drop off or pick up your child without completing the sign-in or sign-out process.

If you are unable to use Brightwheel for any reason, a paper sign-in/sign-out sheet is available at the front desk.

SECTION 12: LATE PICKUP POLICY

The center closes at 6:00 PM, and all children must be picked up by 6:00 PM. If you are running late, you must call the center at (469) 807-1221 as soon as possible to notify us.

Late Pickup Fee

A fee of \$1 per minute applies for every minute after 6:00 PM. The late fee is calculated from 6:00 PM, not from the time you called to notify us. On early-closing days (see Section 2), the fee begins at the posted closing time. Late fees are added to your next tuition payment.

If We Cannot Reach You

If it is 6:30 PM and we have not been able to reach you by phone, we will begin calling the emergency contacts listed in your child's file. If we are unable to reach you or any emergency contact by 7:00 PM, we are required to contact local law enforcement and/or Child Protective Services, as we cannot provide care indefinitely without parental contact.

Chronic Late Pickup

We understand that occasional delays happen. However, when late pickup becomes a regular pattern, it affects staffing and ratio compliance and asks a lot of the caregivers who stay with your child. To keep things fair for everyone, the following applies:

- **1st, 2nd, and 3rd late pickups:** Late fee applied. Verbal reminder from the BHA leadership team.
- **After 3 late pickups:** Written warning issued and placed in the child's file.

- **After 5 late pickups:** The BHA leadership team, including the Executive Director, will meet with the family to discuss the situation. Continued late pickup may result in disenrollment.

Late pickup incidents are tracked on a rolling 12-month basis.

SECTION 13: PARENT COMMUNICATION (BRIGHTWHEEL)

Brightwheel is the primary communication platform at Benevolent House Academy. Through Brightwheel, parents receive daily activity reports and photos, real-time notifications of illness or injury on the day of occurrence, messages about upcoming events, closures, and policy updates, and digital copies of incident reports.

Parents are expected to download the Brightwheel app, create an account, and enable push notifications upon enrollment. Weather closures and delayed openings are announced through Brightwheel only (see Section 44), so push notifications are important. The BHA leadership team will provide setup instructions and an invitation code during the enrollment process.

In addition to Brightwheel, the center communicates important information through posted notices at the front desk, parent conferences (available upon request), and direct phone calls for urgent matters. If you have questions or concerns at any time, you may contact the BHA leadership team at (469) 807-1221 or by email at info@benevolenthouseacademy.org.

SECTION 14: PARENT RIGHTS AND VISITATION

IMPORTANT: Parents may visit the center at any time during hours of operation to observe their child, the program activities, the building, the premises, and the equipment without having to secure prior approval. This is your right under Texas law.

Breastfeeding

Parents have the right to breastfeed their child or provide breast milk for their child while in care. Benevolent House Academy provides a comfortable, private area with an adult-sized seat within the center for mothers who wish to breastfeed. Breast milk must be labeled with the child's name and date and will be stored properly in the refrigerator.

Access to Records and Reports

Parents have the right to review their child's records, the center's most recent licensing inspection report, and the center's operational policies at any time during hours of operation. The most recent inspection report is also posted at the center.

Access to Minimum Standards and Regulatory Information

Parents may access the Texas Minimum Standards for Child-Care Centers (Chapter 746) online at www.hhs.texas.gov/childcare. You may also contact the Texas Abuse and Neglect Hotline at 1-800-252-5400 or visit the HHSC website at www.hhs.texas.gov for additional information about childcare regulation in Texas.

Parent Rights Under Texas Law (TAC 746.521)

Under Texas Administrative Code Section 746.521, a parent of a child enrolled at Benevolent House Academy has the right to:

- Enter and examine the center during hours of operation without advance notice.
- File a complaint against the center.
- Review the center's publicly accessible records.
- Review the center's written records concerning the parent's child.
- Receive HHSC inspection reports for the center and information on how to access the center's compliance history online.
- Have the center comply with a valid court order signed by a judge that prevents another parent from visiting or removing the child.
- Be provided with contact information for HHSC Child Care Regulation, including the department's name, address, and telephone number.
- View any video recordings of an alleged incident of abuse or neglect involving the parent's child, if such recordings are maintained by the center and are available. The parent may not retain any portion of a video depicting another family's child, and the center will notify in writing the parent of any other child captured in the recording before allowing the parent to view it.
- Obtain a copy of the center's policies and procedures.
- Review, upon request, the center's staff training records and its in-house training curriculum, if any.
- Be free from retaliation by the center for exercising any of the rights listed above.

Benevolent House Academy will never retaliate against any parent for exercising any of these rights. If you believe your rights have not been respected, you may contact HHSC Child Care Regulation at 1-800-582-6036.

SECTION 15: PARENT INVOLVEMENT AND PARTICIPATION

Benevolent House Academy welcomes and encourages parent involvement. There are many ways you can participate in your child's experience at the center:

- Volunteer to read in your child's classroom, assist with special events, or share a skill or cultural tradition.
- Attend parent events, open houses, and holiday celebrations hosted by the center.
- Communicate regularly with your child's caregiver and the BHA leadership team about your child's progress, interests, and needs.
- Provide feedback on center policies and activities. Your input helps us improve.

If you are interested in volunteering, please speak with the BHA leadership team. All regular volunteers must complete a background check.

SECTION 16: ILLNESS AND EXCLUSION CRITERIA

To protect the health of all children and staff, children who are ill must not be brought to the center. If your child shows any of the following symptoms, they must stay home:

- Fever of 100.4 degrees F or higher
- Vomiting or diarrhea

- Severe coughing or difficulty breathing
- Undiagnosed rash
- Pink eye (conjunctivitis) with discharge
- Head lice (until treated and nit-free)
- Any condition listed on the Texas DSHS Communicable Disease Chart for Schools and Child-Care Centers

Children may return when they have been symptom-free for at least 24 hours without medication, or when cleared by a physician. Because the center does not administer over-the-counter fever reducers or cough and cold medications (see Section 17), a child who needs this type of medication during the day is considered too ill to remain in care and must be picked up.

Illness During the Day

If your child becomes ill during the day, we will separate them from the group in a supervised area and contact you immediately through Brightwheel and by phone. You or your authorized pickup person must pick up the child within one hour of notification.

Communicable Disease Notification

If a child or employee at the center contracts a communicable disease deemed notifiable by the Texas Department of State Health Services, all parents will be notified in writing within 48 hours. If there is an outbreak of lice or other infestation in your child's group, you will be notified within 48 hours.

SECTION 17: MEDICATION ADMINISTRATION

The center will administer medication to your child only with your written authorization. You must complete a medication authorization form that includes the child's name, medication name, dosage, time and method of administration, and any special instructions.

Products Treated as Medication

For purposes of this section, medication includes any product applied to, taken by, or worn by a child for a health, comfort, or symptom-related purpose. This includes tablets and liquids, and it also includes topical products such as diaper cream, diaper ointment, medicated lotion, teething gel, antibiotic ointment, hydrocortisone, sunscreen, and insect repellent. If a product is applied to your child's skin or worn by your child for one of these purposes, it is handled under this section. Some products are not permitted at all (see Products Not Administered below).

General Requirements

- All medication must be in the original, labeled container with the child's name.
- Prescription medication is administered only as directed on the label and in accordance with the physician's written instructions.

- Medications are stored in a dedicated medication storage area in the office, out of reach of children. Medications requiring refrigeration are stored in a small dedicated refrigerator in the office, separate from food items.
- A medication administration log is maintained and available for parent review.
- Medications are returned to the parent when no longer needed. Expired medications are removed from storage immediately and returned to the parent. If the parent cannot be reached, expired medications are disposed of in accordance with safe disposal practices.
- The caregiver verifies the child's identity, medication name, dosage, time, and route before each administration.

The Product Label Governs

Benevolent House Academy administers over-the-counter products only at or below the dosing, frequency, and age instructions printed on the product label. In accordance with TAC 746.3803(c), a parent may not authorize the center to administer a product in excess of the label instructions or the directions of the child's health-care professional.

The age range printed on the product label controls whether a product may be used for your child. Marketing terms on the front of a package, including the words children's, kids, baby, toddler, natural, herbal, or homeopathic, do not by themselves make a product approvable. Many products marketed for children carry a printed minimum age of two years or older.

A product requested for use outside its printed label, including outside its printed age range, requires a written order from the child's health-care professional before the center will consider the request.

Products Not Administered

Benevolent House Academy does not administer over-the-counter fever reducers, such as acetaminophen or ibuprofen, or cough and cold medications. This applies regardless of parent authorization and regardless of a physician order. A child who has a fever or shows symptoms of contagious illness is sent home in accordance with Section 16 rather than given medication to remain in care.

Benevolent House Academy does not apply, administer, or permit essential oils, vapor rubs, aromatherapy products, medicated patches, or wearable and clip-on diffusers of any kind. These products affect the shared air of the classroom and may trigger asthma symptoms or allergic reactions in other children and staff. This prohibition applies at all ages and is not waived by parent authorization or a physician order.

Commercial Products Only

Only commercial, store-bought products in their original manufacturer container, labeled with the child's first and last name, will be applied or administered. The center does not apply or administer homemade preparations, decanted or repackaged products, products in unmarked containers, or products whose label is missing, illegible, or removed.

Sunscreen and Insect Repellent

Benevolent House Academy does not provide sunscreen or insect repellent. We encourage parents to apply sunscreen before drop-off on days when outdoor play is expected. If you would like staff to reapply sunscreen or apply insect repellent during the day, provide the product in its original container labeled with your child's first and last name, and complete a written authorization form specifying the product, when and how often it should be applied, and any known sensitivities. Only commercial, EPA-registered products will be applied.

Medication and Product Decision Guide

The following table summarizes how requests are handled.

Type of Request	What Is Required
Over-the-counter topical used according to its label (diaper cream, ointment, lotion, sunscreen, insect repellent)	Completed medication authorization form and the product in its original container labeled with the child's first and last name. No physician order required.
Any over-the-counter product requested outside its label, including outside the printed age range, dose, or frequency	Written order from the child's health-care professional, plus the authorization form and original labeled container. Benevolent House Academy may still decline the request.
Over-the-counter fever reducers and cough or cold medications	Not administered under any circumstance. A physician order does not change this. A child who requires this type of medication during the day is considered too ill to remain in care and will be sent home under Section 16.
Prescription medication	Physician's written instructions, completed authorization form, and the medication in its original pharmacy-labeled container bearing the child's name.
Essential oils, vapor rubs, medicated patches, aromatherapy products, and wearable or clip-on diffusers	Not permitted at any age, with or without parent authorization or a physician order. These products affect the shared air of the classroom and may trigger asthma or allergic reactions in other children.

Medication Safety Plan

If a child requires ongoing or emergency medication (such as an epinephrine auto-injector, inhaler, or seizure medication), the parent and the BHA leadership team will develop a written medication safety plan that includes the condition, triggers, medication details, administration instructions, and emergency response steps. The plan is kept in the child's file and a copy is posted in the child's classroom (accessible to staff, not visible to other families).

Unable to Reach Parent Regarding Medication

If a question or concern arises regarding a child's medication and the center is unable to reach the parent after three (3) contact attempts (phone call to parent, then to each emergency contact on file), the center will contact Poison Control at 1-800-222-1222 for guidance. In a

medical emergency, 911 will be called immediately regardless of whether the parent has been reached. Parent authorization is not required to administer medication in a medical emergency to prevent the death or serious bodily injury of a child, per TAC 746.3803(d).

Epinephrine Auto-Injectors

Benevolent House Academy does not maintain an unassigned epinephrine auto-injector at this time. If your child has a known risk of anaphylaxis, you must provide a current, unexpired, prescribed epinephrine auto-injector with a completed medication authorization form and a food allergy emergency plan. The auto-injector will be stored in the child's classroom in a location accessible to staff and out of reach of children.

Requests for exceptions to this section are handled as described in Section 45.

SECTION 18: MEDICAL EMERGENCIES AND INJURIES

In the event of a medical emergency, staff will administer first aid and call 911 for life-threatening situations. Parents will be notified immediately. A written incident report is completed for every injury and illness, signed by the caregiver and the parent, and maintained in the child's file. Parents are notified on the day of occurrence regardless of the severity of the injury.

SECTION 19: HEALTH CHECKS

Caregivers conduct a visual health check of each child upon arrival each day. The health check includes observing the child for signs or symptoms of illness or injury, changes in behavior, and any visible marks or bruises. If a caregiver observes anything of concern, the parent will be asked for an explanation and the observation will be documented. If a child arrives showing signs of illness that meet the exclusion criteria, the parent will be asked to take the child home.

SECTION 20: ALLERGIES AND SPECIAL DIETARY NEEDS

Benevolent House Academy is an egg and nut free facility. Meals and snacks served at the center, and any food brought into the center, including celebration treats, may not contain eggs, peanuts, or tree nuts.

Food allergies and dietary restrictions must be documented at enrollment. If your child has a food allergy, you must provide a completed food allergy emergency plan. Allergy information is posted in the kitchen (first name only) and communicated to all caregivers in your child's classroom. Caregivers verify each child's allergy information before serving meals. If your child has a life-threatening allergy, please discuss an individualized plan with the BHA leadership team before enrollment.

SECTION 21: NUTRITION AND MEALS

Benevolent House Academy participates in the USDA Child and Adult Care Food Program (CACFP). Breakfast, lunch, and afternoon snack are served daily. All meals meet CACFP nutritional guidelines. Weekly menus are posted in the kitchen and near the parent sign-in area.

Outside Food Policy

Benevolent House Academy provides all meals and snacks, and our menu is designed to meet the nutritional needs of all children in care. For this reason, and to keep every child safe around food allergies, we generally ask that food not be brought from home.

If your child has a documented sensory need, religious dietary requirement, or health-based or medical dietary need that cannot be accommodated by the center's menu, you may request to provide your child's meals and snacks from home. In accordance with TAC 746.3309(a), the following conditions apply:

- The parent must sign a written agreement (included in the enrollment agreement or as an addendum) stating that the parent is choosing to provide the child's meals and snacks from home.
- The parent must acknowledge in writing that the center is not responsible for the nutritional value of parent-provided food or for meeting the child's daily food needs.
- All parent-provided food must be labeled with the child's first and last name and date, and stored properly (refrigerated if needed).
- All parent-provided food must be egg and nut free (see Section 20).
- If a parent provides a meal but not a snack, the center will provide the snack.
- Parent-provided food may not be shared with other children. Birthday and celebration treats follow Section 28.

Menu Substitutions and Food Preferences

Benevolent House Academy serves balanced meals and snacks from a planned rotating menu. We understand that families have different needs and preferences, and we handle food substitutions in two ways depending on the reason.

Medical, religious, or documented dietary needs. When a child has a food allergy, a medical dietary restriction, or a religious or cultural dietary practice, the center will make a reasonable substitution from foods we have on hand whenever we are able to do so. For example, when a menu item includes an ingredient a child does not eat for religious or documented reasons, such as pork, the center will offer a comparable alternative on hand (such as a different protein or a meat-free portion) when available. Families are asked to document these needs at enrollment or as soon as they arise so caregivers can plan for them. If a child's dietary needs are specialized or cannot be reliably met from the center's menu, the family may be asked to provide meals from home under the outside food policy above.

Taste and preference substitutions. When a substitution is based on personal preference rather than a medical or religious need, such as a child who is a picky eater or simply dislikes a menu item, the center is not able to prepare individual alternative meals. In these cases, the child is always offered the meal that is served, and no child is ever forced or pressured to eat. If a family prefers their child eat something different due to taste preferences, the family is welcome to provide meals or specific food items from home under the outside food policy above, with the required written agreement on file.

Because the center participates in CACFP, meal substitutions for medical or dietary needs follow CACFP requirements, which generally call for supporting documentation from a health-care professional for a substitution to be reimbursable. This helps ensure every child's needs are met while the center remains in good standing with the food program.

Infant Feeding

Infants are fed according to their individualized feeding plan, which the parent completes at enrollment and updates monthly. Benevolent House Academy provides Similac 360 Total Care formula for infants through 12 months of age. Families who need a specialty formula, prefer a different formula, or whose child uses formula after the first birthday supply their own (see Sections 4 and 5). Breast milk is provided by the parent. Iron-fortified infant cereal and age-appropriate foods are introduced based on the parent's written instructions and the child's developmental readiness. Infants are fed on demand and are never forced to eat.

SECTION 22: PHYSICAL ACTIVITY AND OUTDOOR PLAY

Benevolent House Academy promotes daily physical activity for all children as an essential part of healthy development. Physical activity builds strong bodies, supports brain development, improves coordination, and helps children regulate their energy and emotions.

Benefits of Physical Activity

Regular physical activity supports cardiovascular health, strengthens muscles and bones, improves coordination and balance, builds confidence, enhances social skills through cooperative play, and supports cognitive development and self-regulation. Benevolent House Academy is committed to ensuring that every child has daily opportunities for active movement.

Daily Physical Activity

Children participate in both structured (caregiver-led) and unstructured (child-initiated) physical activities each day. Outdoor play is scheduled at least twice daily for all age groups (staggered by classroom). Indoor physical activity (music and movement, dance, yoga, obstacle courses) is provided when outdoor play is not possible.

Settings for Physical Activity

Physical activity takes place in the following settings: the outdoor play area (primary setting for gross motor activities, riding toys, climbing, running, and group games), individual classrooms (music and movement, yoga, dance, and indoor gross motor activities), and the indoor common area (obstacle courses and large-group movement activities during inclement weather).

Walking Path and Stroller Walks

As part of daily physical activity and fresh-air time, children, including infants in multi-child strollers or buggies, may take supervised walks on our walking path, outside the fenced playground and in the immediate vicinity of the center. These walks are short and are conducted with the following safeguards:

- The center maintains at least the same child-to-caregiver ratio required in the classroom for the entire walk.

- Infants and young children ride in strollers, buggies, or wagons equipped with safety straps, which are fastened at all times during the walk.
- Caregivers stay on the walking path and designated walkways, remain alert to vehicle traffic in the parking lot and surrounding area, and keep children away from moving vehicles at all times.
- A caregiver carries a charged cell phone and the emergency contact information for every child on the walk, and a head count is taken before leaving, during the walk, and upon returning.

By signing the enrollment agreement, parents authorize these routine supervised walks on the walking path. These walks are different from field trips, which involve travel away from the center and require separate written permission as described in Section 30.

Outdoor Play

Children go outside daily unless weather conditions pose a significant health risk. The center uses the following criteria to determine when outdoor play is limited or moved indoors: temperatures at or above 100 degrees F (heat index), temperatures at or below 32 degrees F (wind chill), active thunderstorms or lightning, tornado warnings, heavy rain, ice, or other hazardous conditions as determined by the BHA leadership team.

Physical Activity on Extreme Weather Days

On days when extreme weather limits outdoor play, indoor physical activity is provided to ensure children still have opportunities for active movement. Indoor alternatives include music and movement sessions, dance, yoga, obstacle courses set up in the classroom or common area, and other structured gross motor activities led by caregivers.

Clothing for Physical Activity

Children should wear clothing and closed-toe shoes that allow them to run, climb, and move freely during outdoor and indoor physical activities. Please see Section 26 (Clothing Guidelines) for details.

SECTION 23: SAFE SLEEP POLICY (INFANTS)

IMPORTANT: This policy applies to all infants from 6 weeks through 12 months of age.

- Infants are always placed on their backs to sleep.
- Infants sleep in individual, safety-approved cribs that meet Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) standards.
- Cribs contain a firm mattress and a fitted sheet only. No blankets, pillows, bumper pads, quilts, stuffed animals, toys, sleep positioners, loose sheets, attached pacifiers, pacifiers with clips, cords, or hooks, or any other soft objects or restrictive devices are allowed in the crib.
- Infants are never placed to sleep in swings, bouncers, car seats, or any device that is not a safety-approved crib.
- Infants who fall asleep in a location other than their crib are moved to their crib immediately.

- Swaddling is not permitted at the center.
- Caregivers visually check on sleeping infants frequently.

Parents are asked to review and sign the safe sleep acknowledgment at enrollment.

SECTION 24: NAP AND REST TIME

A daily rest period is provided from approximately 12:30 to 2:30 PM. Infants follow their own individualized sleep schedule. Toddlers and preschool-age children rest on individual cots or rest mats with individual bedding (sheet and lightweight blanket).

Children who do not fall asleep after 30 minutes are provided quiet activities such as books, puzzles, or coloring so as not to disturb sleeping children. We never force a child to sleep. Children who prefer not to nap settle into a calm, quiet rest period with gentle activities, which gives every child a chance to recharge during the day.

SECTION 25: WHAT TO BRING AND LABELING REQUIREMENTS

IMPORTANT: All personal items must be labeled with your child's first and last name. Labeling helps us return items to the right family, as we are not able to be responsible for items that are lost or unlabeled.

- **All children:** A complete change of weather-appropriate clothing (including socks and underwear). A comfort item for nap time (small blanket or stuffed animal for children 12 months and older only).
- **Infants:** If your child requires specialty formula, diapers, or wipes not provided by the center, or uses formula after the first birthday, please bring a sufficient supply labeled with the child's name. Breast milk must be labeled with the child's name and date.

Please see Section 27 for toys from home, jewelry, and other personal items.

SECTION 26: CLOTHING GUIDELINES FOR CHILDREN

Please dress your child in comfortable, weather-appropriate clothing that they can play in freely. Children participate in outdoor play, art, and messy sensory activities daily, so clothing may get dirty.

- Closed-toe shoes are required for all children who are walking. No flip-flops, sandals, or open-toe shoes (they are unsafe for climbing equipment and outdoor play).
- Clothing should be easy for your child to manage independently during toileting (avoid overalls, belts, and complicated snaps for toddlers learning to use the restroom).
- During cold weather, please send a jacket, hat, and gloves. Children go outside daily unless weather conditions are dangerous.
- During warm weather, please apply sunscreen before drop-off. Sunscreen applied at the center is handled under Section 17.

SECTION 27: PERSONAL ITEMS, JEWELRY, AND PROHIBITED ITEMS

The safety of every child in the group is our highest priority. Items that a child can remove, that can come loose, or that can be placed in the mouth present choking and strangulation risks in a group care setting, both to the child wearing the item and to other children in the room. The following policy applies uniformly to all children enrolled at Benevolent House Academy.

Items Worn by Children

Item	Policy
Hair beads, hair ties, barrettes, and hair ornaments secured into braids, twists, or styled hair	Permitted at all ages. Beads and ornaments must be securely fastened into the hair. If an item comes loose during the day, or if a child is observed placing an item in the mouth, staff will remove the item, place it in the child's cubby to go home, and notify the parent that day.
Necklaces, chains, amber teething necklaces, bracelets, anklets, and any item worn around the neck, wrist, or ankle	Not permitted for children under three years of age. This includes amber teething necklaces, which carry documented strangulation and choking risks and have been the subject of federal safety warnings. Permitted for children three years and older.
Clip-on or wearable diffusers, vapor patches, medicated pendants, and aromatherapy jewelry	Not permitted at any age. These are prohibited under Section 17 and are also a removable small-part hazard.
Coins, small toys, small figurines, marbles, and similar small objects	Not permitted for children under three years of age.
Earrings	Permitted at all ages when they are securely fastened studs. Hoops and dangling earrings are not permitted for children under three years of age.

Hair Ornaments

Benevolent House Academy recognizes that beads, ornaments, and decorative fasteners are a normal and valued part of many children's hair care and grooming, and these items are welcome at all ages. We ask only that they be securely fastened. Our concern is a loose small part on the classroom floor, not the style itself. If a bead or ornament comes loose during the day, staff will place it in your child's cubby to go home and will let you know through Brightwheel.

Personal Belongings

Please do not send your child with toys from home unless the classroom has a designated show-and-tell day. Because we are not able to be responsible for personal items that are lost, broken, or misplaced, we ask that you leave items of significant value at home. All personal items must be labeled with your child's first and last name.

Items Found in the Classroom

If staff find an unapproved item on a child or in a child's belongings, the item will be secured out of the reach of children, placed in the child's cubby, and returned to the parent at pickup with a note through Brightwheel. Staff will not return the item to the child during the day.

SECTION 28: BIRTHDAYS AND CELEBRATIONS

We love celebrating your child's birthday! If you would like to provide a treat for your child's classroom, please check with your child's teacher or the BHA leadership team before purchasing, at least 3 days in advance, so we can confirm the class count and any allergies in the room.

- Treats must be store-bought, in the original package, with the ingredient label attached. Homemade food cannot be served.
- Benevolent House Academy is an egg and nut free facility. Treats cannot contain eggs, peanuts, or tree nuts, or carry a "may contain" warning for them.
- The BHA leadership team checks each treat against the allergy list for your child's classroom before it is served.
- Please provide enough for every child in the classroom.
- Non-food goody bags and items such as stickers or small books are welcome. For children under 3, please avoid small toys and other items that are choking hazards (see Section 27).
- Please do not distribute individual party invitations at the center unless every child in the classroom is invited.

For our youngest friends: Infants under 12 months enjoy the celebration with songs and attention rather than treats, and eat only what is on their feeding plan. For children under 4, please avoid popcorn, hard candy, marshmallows, and whole grapes, which are choking hazards for little ones.

SECTION 29: ANIMALS

Benevolent House Academy does not keep animals or pets at the center. No animals are permitted on the premises during operating hours except for a special educational activity (such as a classroom visit from a local nature organization), in which case parents will be notified in advance. Children will only interact with animals under direct adult supervision, and any child with a known allergy to animals will be accommodated. All children wash their hands after any contact with animals.

SECTION 30: FIELD TRIPS

Field trips are part of our school-age summer program (coming soon). If Benevolent House Academy schedules a field trip, written parental authorization is obtained for each field trip before departure. Child-to-caregiver ratios are maintained at all times. Each caregiver carries a roster with emergency contacts, a first aid kit is taken on all trips, and head counts are conducted before departure, at every transition, and upon return. Parents will be notified of upcoming field trips through Brightwheel with details about the destination, date, time, and any items needed.

SECTION 31: WATER ACTIVITIES

Benevolent House Academy does not offer water activities. The center does not provide sprinkler play, water tables, wading pools, or swimming pools, and children are not taken off-site for any water activities. No swimming pools or wading pools are located at the center.

SECTION 32: TRANSPORTATION

Benevolent House Academy does not provide transportation at this time. Before BHA transports any child, including for summer field trips, families will receive the center's written transportation policy, and written parental authorization will be obtained.

SECTION 33: WEEKEND AND EVENING CARE

Benevolent House Academy is licensed for 24-hour care. Weekend daytime care for children ages 2 through 13 and evening care for children ages 2 and older are coming soon. Before either program begins, families will receive the schedule, rates, what to bring, and any additional policies in writing.

SECTION 34: EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS

Benevolent House Academy maintains a written Emergency Preparedness Plan addressing fire, severe weather, lockdown, and other emergencies. Evacuation routes are posted in every room. Drills are conducted on the following schedule:

- **Fire drills:** Monthly.
- **Severe weather drills:** Quarterly.
- **Lockdown drills:** Quarterly.

In the event of an emergency requiring evacuation, children and staff will relocate to a designated relocation site. Whenever the emergency allows, children and staff will first relocate to the Benevolent House offices located next door. Benevolent House Academy maintains the following designated relocation sites:

- Benevolent House, 504 SH-342, Red Oak, TX 75154 (primary relocation site, located next door)
- Red Oak Fire Department, 111 Live Oak Street, Red Oak, TX 75154 (offsite relocation site)

The specific relocation site used will depend on the nature, location, and timing of the emergency. The BHA leadership team member or designee in charge will determine the appropriate site based on the circumstances. Parents will be notified immediately through Brightwheel push notifications and phone calls with the specific relocation address. Emergency records for all children are transported with the group. A complete copy of the Emergency Preparedness Plan is available at the center for parent review upon request.

SECTION 35: CHILD ABUSE AND NEGLECT PREVENTION AND REPORTING

Every employee at Benevolent House Academy is a mandatory reporter under Texas law. Our staff is trained to recognize the signs of child abuse and neglect and to report suspected abuse immediately.

Prevention and Awareness

Benevolent House Academy is committed to preventing child abuse and neglect and to increasing awareness among employees and families. The center maintains the following practices:

- **Annual Employee Training.** All employees complete annual training on recognizing the signs and symptoms of child abuse and neglect, understanding risk factors, and fulfilling their legal obligation to report. This training is documented in each employee's personnel file.
- **Warning Signs and Risk Factors.** The center educates employees and parents on warning signs that a child may be a victim of abuse or neglect and factors that may place a child at increased risk. Information is shared during new employee orientation, annual staff training, and through parent resources available at the front desk.
- **Prevention Techniques.** Employees are trained in prevention techniques, including maintaining appropriate boundaries with children, proper supervision practices, and creating a safe environment. The center promotes open communication between families and staff to support early identification and intervention.
- **Community Coordination.** Benevolent House Academy coordinates with community organizations, including DFPS, local law enforcement, and family support agencies, to support child safety and connect families with resources when needed.

How to Report Suspected Abuse or Neglect

Parents are not required to report concerns to the center before contacting a regulatory agency. You may contact any of the following directly at any time:

- **Texas DFPS Abuse and Neglect Hotline:** 1-800-252-5400 (24 hours a day, 7 days a week)
- **Online:** www.txabusehotline.org

How to Contact Licensing

If you have concerns about this center or any childcare operation, you may contact:

- **HHSC Child Care Regulation (local office):** 1-800-582-6036 or (214) 583-4253
- **HHSC Website:** www.hhs.texas.gov/childcare

SECTION 36: IMMUNIZATION REQUIREMENTS

Each child enrolled at Benevolent House Academy must meet the immunization requirements specified by the Texas Department of State Health Services (DSHS) for their age. Current immunization records must be provided at enrollment and kept up to date throughout the child's enrollment.

Exemptions are available for medical reasons (signed by a physician) or for reasons of conscience, including religious beliefs (using the official DSHS affidavit form, which must be notarized). Children on provisional enrollment must complete required immunizations within the timelines established by DSHS rules.

Tuberculosis (TB) screening or testing will be required only if mandated for our area by the regional Texas Department of State Health Services or the local health authority. If TB screening or testing is required, families will be notified.

In addition to immunization records, each child who does not attend school away from the center must have a health-care professional's statement on file confirming the child is able to take part in the program. If a parent enrolls under the option to provide this statement within 12

months of admission (as noted on Form 2935), the parent is responsible for obtaining and submitting the signed statement before that 12-month deadline. The center will remind families as the deadline approaches, but it remains the parent's responsibility to submit it on time so the child's file stays complete and compliant.

SECTION 37: HEARING AND VISION SCREENING

Texas law requires hearing and vision screening for children ages 4 and older. Parents are responsible for ensuring their child receives the required screenings and providing documentation to the center. Screenings may be obtained through your child's pediatrician, local school district, or a community screening event. If you need assistance locating a screening provider, the BHA leadership team can provide referrals.

SECTION 38: LIABILITY INSURANCE NOTICE

As of the date of this handbook, Benevolent House Academy does not carry liability insurance, as permitted under Texas Administrative Code Section 746.205. This is common for new child-care operations during their initial period of licensure, and the center is working toward obtaining coverage. You were or will be provided with a separate written notice (Attachment A) about this before your child is admitted into care. You are required to sign that notice before your child's first day. A copy of the signed notice is maintained in your child's file.

When insurance is obtained, the center will carry a minimum of \$300,000 per occurrence as required by TAC 746.203, and families will be notified in writing.

SECTION 39: GANG-FREE ZONE NOTICE

Under the Texas Penal Code, any area within 1,000 feet of a child-care center is a gang-free zone. Criminal offenses related to organized criminal activity that occur in a gang-free zone are subject to harsher penalties under Texas law.

SECTION 40: INCLUSIVE SERVICES FOR CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL CARE NEEDS

Benevolent House Academy is committed to providing inclusive care for all children, including children with disabilities, developmental delays, or other special care needs, in compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). We will make reasonable accommodations to support your child's participation in our program.

If your child receives Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) services or special education services, we welcome qualified service providers to deliver those services at our center with your written request and approval. We will work with you and your child's service providers to adapt activities, equipment, and routines as needed.

Caregivers integrate children with and without special care needs into all activities and adapt equipment and procedures as necessary to ensure that children with special needs are cared for in a natural environment.

If your child has special care needs, please discuss them with the BHA leadership team during the enrollment process so we can develop an appropriate plan together.

SECTION 41: VACCINE-PREVENTABLE DISEASES

Benevolent House Academy maintains a policy on vaccine-preventable diseases as required by TAC 746.3611. The center encourages all employees to stay current on recommended immunizations to protect the health of children in care. Information about vaccine-preventable diseases and the center's employee immunization practices is available from the BHA leadership team upon request.

SECTION 42: QUESTIONS, CONCERNS, AND GRIEVANCES

We value open communication with our families. If you have questions, concerns, or feedback about your child's care, classroom activities, or center policies, we encourage you to speak with the BHA leadership team. Most concerns can be resolved through a direct conversation.

Parents are welcome to review and discuss any of the center's policies and procedures with the BHA leadership team at any time. If you would like to schedule a meeting to discuss a specific policy, please call (469) 807-1221 or email info@benevolenthouseacademy.org.

If your concern is not resolved to your satisfaction, you may contact the Executive Director, Tanya Orr, by phone at (469) 807-1221 or by email at info@benevolenthouseacademy.org.

If you believe your concern involves a violation of licensing standards or child safety, you may also contact HHSC Child Care Regulation at 1-800-582-6036 or the DFPS Abuse and Neglect Hotline at 1-800-252-5400. You are never required to go through the center first before contacting a regulatory agency.

SECTION 43: TERMINATION OF SERVICES AND WITHDRAWAL

Withdrawal by the Parent

If you wish to withdraw your child from Benevolent House Academy, you must provide at least two weeks of written notice to the BHA leadership team. To give written notice, please complete the BHA Withdrawal Notice form, available from the BHA leadership team. A written notice by email is also accepted. Tuition is due in full during the two-week notice period regardless of whether your child attends. If two weeks of notice is not possible, tuition still applies through the end of the two-week notice period, since that time is reserved for your child.

If a child does not attend for 5 consecutive business days with no communication from the parent, the center will make reasonable attempts to contact the family. If no contact is made after 10 consecutive business days, the child may be disenrolled and the spot may be offered to the next family on the waitlist.

Disenrollment by the Center

Benevolent House Academy reserves the right to disenroll a child for any of the following reasons:

- Nonpayment of tuition. If tuition is more than 2 weeks past due and no payment arrangement has been made with the BHA leadership team, the child may be disenrolled with 5 business days of written notice.
- Chronic late pickup (see Late Pickup Policy).

- Behavior that poses a persistent safety risk to the child, other children, or staff after the behavior escalation process has been followed (see Section 9).
- Falsification of enrollment records, immunization records, or any other documentation.
- Verbal or physical abuse, threats, or harassment directed at staff, other parents, or children by the parent or any authorized pickup person.
- Repeated violation of center policies after written warnings.
- Failure to provide required documentation (immunization records, health statement, allergy plan) within the timelines required by licensing.

Notice of Disenrollment

For non-safety reasons, the center will provide the family with 5 business days of written notice before disenrollment takes effect. The notice will include the reason for disenrollment and the effective date.

For safety reasons (including but not limited to threats of violence, a parent arriving under the influence of drugs or alcohol, or a child's behavior that poses an immediate danger after all interventions have been exhausted), disenrollment may be effective immediately. The center will provide written documentation of the reason as soon as practicable.

Refunds

If the center initiates disenrollment, any tuition paid in advance for days after the effective disenrollment date will be refunded. Registration fees are non-refundable. If a family withdraws without the two weeks of notice, tuition for the notice period is not refunded, as that time was held for the child.

SECTION 44: WEATHER CLOSURES AND CENTER CLOSURES

Benevolent House Academy follows Red Oak ISD for weather closures and delayed openings. If Red Oak ISD closes due to weather, BHA is closed. If Red Oak ISD delays its start, BHA opens at the same time Red Oak ISD schools open that day.

How Families Are Notified

- **Morning closures and delayed openings:** Announced through Brightwheel only. Individual phone calls, text messages, and emails are not sent, so please keep Brightwheel push notifications turned on.
- **Early closures during the day:** If weather worsens and the center needs to close early, families are notified through Brightwheel and by phone call. Please pick up your child as soon as it is safe to do so.
- **Other emergencies:** If a power outage or other emergency makes it unsafe to operate, families are notified through Brightwheel as early as possible.

Tuition During Closures

Tuition is due regardless of weather-related closures. If the center is closed for 5 or more consecutive business days, tuition credits will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis by the Executive Director.

SECTION 45: POLICY AUTHORITY, EXCEPTIONS, AND UNIFORM APPLICATION

Decision-Making Authority

The BHA leadership team oversees all questions involving medication, topical products, personal items, jewelry, safety exceptions, and the interpretation of the policies in this handbook. The Executive Director has the final say on any matter the leadership team does not resolve. Classroom teachers, caregivers, floaters, and administrative staff are not authorized to approve exceptions to these policies, and a parent should not interpret a staff member's response at the door as an approval.

Requests for any exception must be submitted in writing through Brightwheel to the BHA leadership team. The BHA leadership team will respond in writing. A verbal approval is not effective.

The Center May Decline a Request

Completing an authorization form, providing a labeled product, or obtaining a physician order permits the center to consider a request. It does not obligate the center to approve it. Benevolent House Academy may decline any product, item, or accommodation that presents a safety risk in a group care setting, presents a risk to other children in the classroom, or cannot be safely supervised at the applicable child-to-caregiver ratio. This determination rests with the BHA leadership team, and the Executive Director has the final say.

Policies Apply Uniformly

These policies apply to every enrolled child and every family. Exceptions are considered only through the written process above, and an approval or accommodation for one child does not create a precedent for another. Applying our policies consistently is how we keep every classroom safe and how we make sure that every family is treated fairly.

We recognize that families will have questions about how a policy applies to their child, and we welcome those questions. Please direct them to the BHA leadership team so that you receive a complete and accurate answer in writing.

SECTION 46: PARENT ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF RECEIPT

I, the undersigned parent or legal guardian, acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Benevolent House Academy Parent Handbook (revised October 2026). I have read and understand the policies and procedures described in this handbook. This handbook replaces all prior versions of the Parent Handbook and any prior amendments.

I understand the policies regarding tuition and rate placement, medication and topical products, personal items and jewelry, and weather closures and notifications. I understand that these policies apply uniformly to all enrolled children, that requests for exceptions must be submitted in writing to the BHA leadership team, and that a verbal approval from a staff member is not effective.

I understand that Benevolent House Academy reserves the right to modify, amend, or update the policies in this handbook at any time. I will be notified of any changes in writing and will receive an updated copy.

I understand that my signed enrollment agreement and this acknowledgment serve as confirmation that I have been informed of the center's operational policies as required by Texas Administrative Code Chapter 746.

I understand that I may visit the center at any time during hours of operation to observe my child without prior approval.

Parent or Guardian Signature

Date

Parent or Guardian Printed Name

Child's Name

Classroom

The signed acknowledgment is maintained in the child's file at the center.